

TWO BASIC WAYS OF LIFE -- TOWARDS AND AWAY FROM THE CENTER

Greetings, all my dearest friends. I should like to start this lecture with a special blessing whose deeper meaning you can feel if you are open to it. Otherwise, the words will not mean more to you than just words. This blessing is the simple statement, truth brings love and love brings truth. From whichever end you start it or are able to start it, one must lead to the other, and both become one. This pathwork is concerned with tentatively groping in both directions.

In the very center of man's personality exists a potent, white-glowing mass of energy. It is a constant fire that explodes within itself over and over again in a bubbling mass. Each of these minute explosions multiplies the mass so that kernels are expelled which are of the same substance and energy mass. When this fundamental creative process is not obstructed and the ongoing process is functional and harmonious, the endless continuum of creation spreads and floods over with joy and well-being. The constant flow of movement spreads more and more and is yet contained within itself in an orderly fashion. There is no chaos in this process.

Wherever this creative energy mass manifests, it brings into the respective organism the very essence and nature of the creative substance. As I said, it is joy and well-being. But this is not all. Since it is the divine mass, it must contain consciousness of the highest order. Each bubbling, exploding, spreading kernel is a nucleus of consciousness with infinite potentials of wisdom, intelligence, knowing, talent, creativity, resources of every conceivable possibility. In this consciousness, infinite modes of self-expression, bliss, pleasure supreme, and stimulating change of new ventures exist in the most peaceful and secure state. All words to be used cannot remotely do it justice. Each kernel contains everything that ever was, ever will be, and ever can be. If these words are truly understood in their far-reaching significance and are taken literally, as they are meant to be, nothing can ever appear hopeless to an unhappy human being.

The combination of consciousness and energy is truly all-powerful. It is the omnipotence correctly ascribed to God and misinterpreted by the child whose inner knowing of its own inherent omnipotence makes it abuse it. The abuse occurs by putting it into the service of the self-willed, little ego. The latter must be overcome in order to find man's own divine nucleus where real omnipotence reigns supreme.

Human beings are vastly ignorant of the fact that they express part of this ever exploding, ever increasing energy mass of consciousness and power. They may have certain theories and accept certain philosophies that postulate these truths, but they are not deeply aware of being a part, an expression of this powerhouse of strength and wisdom. All life, the meaning of all life, is concerned with bringing this state about in which the organic process of the energy mass takes place without interruption, without hindrance, without obstruction. The human state of consciousness has obstructed to a considerable degree this ever creative unfolding process. The state of development

of an individual can be gauged by to what extent he is conscious of this fact and to what extent he makes forever more room for this process to take place.

These are facts, my friends, which you already know in principle. However, they have to be brought to your attention again and again in forever new terms, with a new light and different angle, so that finally an inroad can be made that leads to an emotional experience of these truths. First a vivid new experience in the mind can take place, which then gives the necessary stimulation and perhaps a new feeling of comprehension so that the obstructing mechanism becomes weaker and the creative expansion process stronger in impetus.

The human state of consciousness finds itself in a state in which the individual can take either of two very basic directions of life. They are the fundamental ways of life an individual has chosen. One is toward this unfoldment and the elimination of obstruction. The other is away from it. The human condition can be adequately explained by stating that it is a struggle to give up the one way of life and find into the other. The majority of human beings, as they still are as of today, are still oblivious of this choice and still move away from the center. They strive to find a happiness that can only be found in the opposite direction. Since they are ignorant of containing within themselves all they could ever need, they try to grasp what they need away from themselves -- from others, from substitutes, from illusions.

As stated, the direction toward the center is an infinite process. There is no stopping, no end result, no goal. It is forever new, increasing with expanded vistas and possibilities of blissful ways of being and of self-expression. The multitude and variety contained in this creative force make boredom impossible, nor do they bring fatigue since fatigue is merely a result of the opposite forces set in motion by striving in the other direction. The incredibly beautiful state of being cannot possibly be conveyed in words. You must also imagine that this state knows no fear whatsoever since the absolute knowing exists that there is never an end to blissful life, there is only more and better of all possible choices. This is truly no illusion, my friends. It is the stark reality of the inner life of creative being. Fearlessness results when the individual knows that all good can be had and need never end as long as it is chosen.

The other direction, away from the center, is finite. The more the individual moves into this direction, the more he is in despair -- not only because it is the wrong way, the way that leads to destructiveness and unhappiness, but also because an end is feared. Only, the end is feared in the wrong way. It is believed that actually existing and all hope of bliss end forever. Since the creative kernel in each human entity is so strongly filled with its own nature, which is this bliss, all human beings long for the fulfillment of their inherent nature. When this fulfillment seems to move further and further away, man believes that there is no other hope or solution in sight. In that sense, the perception of "the end" is incorrect. But the perception that there is an end is correct in that there is a limit after which no further way out exists in the direction one has taken. This direction truly leads to an end. There must come a breaking point, a collapse, because this direction leads to an entrapment from which there is no way out. Seen in this light, it is actually a blessing to arrive at this breaking point. Only when this breaking point has been reached can the other direction be found. Only when the entity recognizes, "I am in a state from which there is no way out, the old way is wrong," can the other way be found -- not otherwise.

I would like to point out here that every entity on the road toward unfoldment and the activation of the center, everyone who is moving in the right direction so that life is a fruitful and constructive experience, has reached this breaking point at a previous period of his spiritual history. Such a person, too, must have been at the "point of no return" where absolute despair reigned and there seemed no way out. This motivated him into a new way of operation, a different approach and direction. Thus it is often folly to assume it is a tragic occurrence when a person obviously moves quite rapidly into this "point of collapse and no return." It is a necessary thing when an entity is still completely blind and entrapped in error and destruction. The "breaking point" is then the healing power, the only possibility from which the good way can be looked for, seen, and undertaken. The marvel of the universe, of creation, is that the more rapidly destruction is approached, the nearer the salvation of ultimate bliss must be. Hence, reaching the "breaking point" of no further way out has a deep importance for the development of each entity. This leads directly to the right direction, to the bliss of coming into one's own and finding the power of the spiritual force inside -- its explosive power, its ongoing process of positive unfoldment, of endless delight, of unlimited possibilities for pleasurable and meaningful existence, of real selfhood, of the dignity of being a creator of one's own life in the universe, of expressing God within oneself. This direction is only found after a breaking point has been reached.

In small ways, I venture to say that every one of you has experienced this innumerable times in your life. You have come to desperation where you thought there was no way out. Then something in you changed because you found yourself conscious of a tense insistence in one specific direction. As long as it was not desperate, you hoped from this direction a desired result would come. Only when it was clear that this was not the case did you give up this tense insistence. Something in you relaxed -- you let go of the old direction -- and lo and behold, the desperation vanished. Solutions occurred in a completely unexpected way. Only by having reached the very limits of the old direction, when the insistence has no longer any hope, out of sheer desperation did you find the way that leads to all you could ever want. In small ways, you have experienced it many times. The old insistence, the old beliefs, the old stubbornness and destructive patterns are often not given up unless you are at this very last phase of the old road. Every entity experiences this in every life in many small ways, and it reappears in every entity's cycle of lives. But in a principal way, I might say that there is one very significant point when this happens on an overall plane. You might also look at the human race from this point of view, and look at all the people in your environment, and see how many are basically still on the road toward the finite breaking point, where the limit is reached, and how this limit is feared, and yet how stubbornly they refuse to look for another way. And then you see a few individuals who are on the upper unfolding way, moving toward their own inner center, who have obviously the major breaking point behind them. And then, of course, when you evaluate human existence from this point of view, you will come to see that the latter is indeed a very small minority. You here, on this path, are therefore a very small minority. And even you who are here groping with your personal inner problems and struggles, you also are still bent, at times, unconsciously and unknowingly in the old automatism on the wrong road that has been instituted for centuries in many cases. Only as you see more and more of yourself do you eventually see this process -- the destructive process that leads to this limit from which the way cannot continue in the same direction. At least now, you are meaningfully preoccupied to ascertain this fact about yourselves.

The human personality is of course an integral part of this great power and the creative substance I mentioned. When I say the human personality, I actually mean everything about it -- the

conscious intelligence, the will, all the capacities and feelings, unfolded or only slumbering as potentials. Since destructiveness and evil are not verities in themselves, but only distortions, they are included. The conscious ego personality is not a separated, different thing. Its very nature is of the same substance and contains all the elements to be found in the nucleus of being. Therefore it would also be an error to approach your self-realization as though your ego personality were basically and intrinsically different from the inner power you are about to activate. Nevertheless, as you know, the ego, as it is developed now, is very limited in power and intelligence in comparison with the larger, vaster part you wish to activate through this pathwork. It is therefore necessary for you to comprehend that whatever is at your disposal -- the conscious personality, although it is limited in comparison -- contains everything you need in order to activate and become one with this explosive power, that ever unfolding power of love and truth and consciousness and strength and creative living that is the God consciousness itself. Although the ego consciousness is ill equipped to handle life by itself, it is nevertheless perfectly endowed with everything you need for every conceivable situation you are in, to assume the attitude necessary that brings you into union with the greater power. This is a tremendously important knowledge for you to have. Without this knowledge you think you must despair and you are powerless, while with this comprehension you can grope in a hopeful and meaningful way. If you could, at each difficulty, at each bend in the road where you cannot see around it, say "Yes, I have right now at my disposal everything I need to find the attitude compatible with the greater power," this power can make itself know to you. What is the attitude you have toward the present difficulty? This is what counts, and this is where you have a choice to assume a constructive or destructive attitude, a truthful or a self-deceptive attitude. You have the power to find out what you really feel and why you feel what you feel. You have the power to request guidance from the greatest wisdom conceivable, within yourself. You have the possibility to want to be on the constructive road that leads to building up, to creating, to unfolding, rather than giving up as is done so often in a difficulty. At the same time, you also have the power to let go of stubborn insistence and rigid upholding of unconscious attitudes whose nature are as yet unexplored. You have the power to overcome the temptation to indulge in resignation and self-pity. Therefore I say to you, realize that you have everything you need in order to assume the attitude to activate the greatest power in the universe. Each and every living instant -- I do not care whether it is beautiful or ugly, easy and lighthearted or difficult and heavy -- contains the potential to be in bliss, provided you penetrate the now to its deepest level. Each instant contains ultimate truth if you but want to turn into the right direction.

These words may not be easy to accept and perhaps even more difficult to feel. But if you begin by contemplating this, if you start -- at any given moment of your road toward light, truth, love, and fulfillment -- to think about this, and take this sentence very seriously, and do something with the meaning of this sentence, I say, where there is darkness, light will come; where hopelessness seems a fact of life, ever increasing possibilities of new expansion will dawn upon you, as the starkest reality you have ever experienced. Each second of your life contains the All and the Ultimate. This is not a mere phrase; it is absolute and stark reality, forever realizable. Even if you move, still in your error, toward the limit point where the turnabout must come, even that is good if it is truly understood, the understanding groped for honestly, asked for, prayed for. Suddenly it will assume a new meaning.

In order to make all this a little easier to realize, let us look at a very important obstruction. We talked about many obstructions such as the errors, the misconceptions, the destructive attitudes, in many ways and from many approaches. At this time, I would like to make it very simple. I would

like to discuss this in terms of the soul movements, which are a reflection of the personality's attitudes. If you become more finely attuned to the soul movements, you will perceive very easily that each attitude you assume results in a certain movement. If you are in an attitude of love, say, the soul movement is very different from an attitude of fear and hate.

The greatest and most hindering factor is fear, especially unconscious, repressed, unrecognized fear. It must be clearly understood that these words are directed at the level after repression has been made conscious, for not knowing what goes on in the self is obviously the greatest obstruction there is. It is also more responsible than any other single factor for fear. Every destructiveness is connected with fear -- either comes from it and/or leads to it and perpetuates it. Fear is a tremendously important element. The soul movement of fear is tension, cramp, and stopping of the flow, the flow that comes from the inner energy center that enlivens man. Fear blocks the opening wherever increased self-renewing new life flows into the outer organism. In extension of the last lecture, fear breeds nonmovement. It freezes, paralyzes, stops movement. It is thus accurate to state that the soul movement of fear is no movement. Thus it is of great importance that fear be understood in terms of the dynamics of the soul movements.

We discussed many elements of fear in this work. You have found what some of your fears are, why you are afraid, what misconceptions exist that create fear, etc. I do not wish to go into this topic now from that angle. I say to those of you who are not aware of your fears when you are unhappy, you must have fear if there is anything that burdens or frustrates you. If you feel that your self-expression is hindered, if you feel that there is more to life than what you experience, then you must have fears you do not know about. This fear must eventually be experienced in order for you to come out of it.

As I said, the dynamics of fear is tension, a cramp, paralysis. Such a cramp prohibits the creative flow. If you go deep enough and truly confront the fear dispassionately, you must always recognize that it comes from a very strong, cramped, stubborn, insistent desire for something. Some philosophies will even preach desirelessness because they have recognized this fact, although this can easily be misunderstood, as I discussed at a much earlier period when I was asked about this. Desirelessness must not be confused with indifference, stagnation, resignation, escape from the conflicts that one's desires may bring in an as yet undeveloped state. Healthy desires are relaxed. They are in rhythm with this unfolding, inwardly exploding life energy. The cramped desire is the one that breeds fear, the desire that says, "I must or else. I will not take no for an answer." This is the kind of desire that breeds fear, for this is the kind of desire that comes out of distrust and actually comes out of fear. "I must, I will not give up" denies the ever unfolding life possibilities. Therefore it insists on one specific thing, at one specific moment, in one specific way. Therefore it reveals distrust, ignorance of the universe, fear that one may not get one's own -- and it comes out of the darkness that does not see other ways and possibilities but the one insisted on. Therefore it cramps itself up within itself.

Strong desire of this nature is always behind fear. When this desire is experienced, acknowledged, examined, it is always seen that distrustful elements are behind it. So I say to you, my friends, look at your fears from this point of view. Only as you can give up and let go the specific desires that are behind the fear, will the fear vanish and will the soul movement relax. For the greatest inner pain is the cramped soul movement. Thus room will be made for the endless possibilities within yourself, within your own inner universe, for new unfoldment.

Sometimes this may mean to abandon a desire entirely because it is found to be destructive in itself. At other times, the desire itself is perfectly valid, but the way it insists on being realized is unrealistic and leads to pain and disappointment. At still other times, again the desire may be valid by itself, but the reason or motivation may come from destructive attitudes -- dependent, self-alienating trends. Try to ascertain the desires behind each fear. This is my advice, my suggestion, my message to you tonight. If you truly pray for this inner understanding and this inner action, something will very drastically change you.

Now are there any questions in connection with this lecture?

QUESTION: Yes. Letting go of these desires, is this an act of will that takes place?

ANSWER: Yes, it is the inner will. Often the desire itself may be legitimate and even healthy, as I implied before. But it is the insistence, "I must have this now" or "I must not have that now," that is so harmful. What I advise is not necessarily giving up the desire per se. It is giving up that cramped soul movement that is connected with having the desire. It is a conscious decision that is directed toward the inner feeling self, where you feel yourself letting go of something, giving up a certain attitude. Let us take a simple example which is so universal that it is applicable to everyone. The fear of death contains the desire to live. There is nothing at all wrong with this desire, for it is creation's fact and truth that life is unending. But the fear of death contains every false attitude I discussed in this lecture. Physical death is, on a certain level, the final breaking point of the limitation reached of the road away from the center. Since every human being incarnated is in the state of moving away from the center to a greater or lesser degree, everyone must go through the experience of death. Therefore this limit is feared and cramped up against. But denying the result of one's own action is an unreasonable inner act. It implies not assuming the responsibility and the consequences for one's actions and choices. If you go east and wish to come out west, cramp up against coming out west while all the while continuing on the road toward east, you will be in grave conflict with yourself and life. Accepting death in the right way merely means assuming the consequences of one's past direction. It need not at all mean to abandon one's desire to live. In fact, the desire to be dead is far from healthy. It stems from morbid fears and from escape. Thus I do not say that, in order to overcome death and the fear of death, the desire for life must be abandoned.

What I do say is that the healthy attitude leading toward life would be an attitude somewhat like this, "Here is death coming. I do not know whether I will continue life. I would like to continue life. My outer intellect only knows the theories of a continuum of life and the philosophies of it, but I do not as yet experience the truth of it in my inner feelings. I would like this eternal life, if it exists. I will not deceive myself, though, by pretending that I feel the truth of a continuum of life. I let go of the fear that I will not live, and accept what comes in the trust that the universe is benign even if I cannot at this time know, see, and experience the continuum I would like." This is the attitude that will eventually bring one the inner experience of the truth that life is unending. How soon this will come depends on how genuine this attitude is and how deeply it is experienced. And how effectively the trusting letting go, letting oneself be carried, while, at the same time, being honest where one is in this respect, determines how soon the experience will make itself felt that there is nothing to fear. For life, indeed, is an unending process.

QUESTION: How can you get fear out of your system?

ANSWER: You can get fear out of your system by recognizing everything I said here, what is behind it, where do you hold on in a cramped state, and by letting go of the cramp, by meeting the fear head on rather than evading it. Fear is maintained always because it is not faced. When it is faced, these things can be recognized, experienced, and altered according to reality and a more constructive pattern of life. Thus the cramped hardened mass opens up. You will feel it. In this action, there is always implied a generous attitude of trust toward the universe. I said in this lecture that every single instant of living contains the possibilities of choosing the attitudes that will bring you into contact with the eternal life within you. Actually, contact is not a sufficient word -- the eternal life will completely permeate and fill you with its reality. If you are in fear, therefore cramped, therefore alienated from the life force in you, you must really face the fear on the deepest level (not on a superimposed, projected one). When you come to the cramped desire behind the basic fear, then you see the meaning of the cramped desire. It spells out, "I do not trust the universe. I want it my way. I do not give myself to the universe." This is ungenerous and untrusting. This very same attitude is incompatible with the nature of the divine center so that the experience of the latter is blocked. When this attitude is exchanged for generous trust, then you will experience the truth of this benign universe in which nothing need be feared.

QUESTION: How can I synchronize feeling and movement?

ANSWER: The inability to do this reveals a tremendous frozenness that is also a result of fear -- for instance, fear that if you express your feelings, you must move out into the world. You fear that by doing so certain unwelcome results will occur. Here, too, you must ask yourself precisely what it is you fear if you move with your feelings. Perhaps you fear rejection, ridicule, hurt, disapproval, but whatever they may be, you have to state the fears, you have to concisely know them. Only then can the courage and generosity come that make you take the risk. There must be risk involved. Apart from all the other things I said about fear, it is also a refusal to risk anything. It is impossible to lose fear if the willingness to lose does not exist. This means risking. Not wanting to risk is ungenerous. And anything ungenerous is incompatible with the nature of the power you wish to unite with. In order to be activated by this inner reality of being, become one with it, be enlivened by it, know and express it, the outer personality must be compatible with it -- in its nature, its attitudes, its laws, in its very way of being. These are natural and logical laws. If your character and your attitudes are incompatible with the laws of the greater power deep within your center, you cannot possibly express this greater power. Not trusting the universe, not ever wanting to take a risk, is a pettiness of spirit. Wherever human conflicts and problems reside in the soul, this pettiness also exists.

Thus I say, the only way is to face exactly what it is you fear, what it is you want, and where it is you ungenerously withhold from trusting and risking. That is the only way out of fear. There is no other. Fear is completely a result of duality. You see, if you want so strongly you must fear so strongly not to get what you want. To put it in the opposite way, if you fear so strongly, you automatically must want so much what you do not wish to experience. In this too strong wanting and not wanting is not only a cramp, there is also the duality -- yes versus no, good versus bad. Duality must end in conflict, comes out of conflict, and therefore must wind up at the breaking point of no return. The limit finally offers no other alternative but to turn around where the unitive principle will reveal itself in its fearless, conflictless state. Then a soul movement exists where

neither yes nor no is overly strong, not because one has no desire to expand in bliss -- for this is the natural desire -- but because one trusts the universe and its laws that it will come without the ego's cramp of saying too much yes or no.

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